What you need

- Windows 10 or 11 laptop; Chrome or Edge; internet once (for the install only).
- Optional: 80 mm thermal printer + driver; a second laptop for Counter 2; Google Drive for Desktop.

Install (do once)

1. Install Python: download https://www.python.org/ftp/python/3.13.17/python-3.13.17-amd64.exe, run it, tick **Add python.exe to PATH**, click **Install Now**, wait for **Setup was successful**.
2. Download the app: open https://github.com/thiruvenkatesanr13/sri-vinayaga-crackers-billing → green **Code** button → **Download ZIP**.
3. Unblock the ZIP: right-click it → **Properties** → tick **Unblock** → **OK**.
4. Extract it: right-click → **Extract All**.
5. Move and rename the extracted sri-vinayaga-crackers-billing-main folder to C:\SriVinayagaBilling (not on Desktop, Downloads, OneDrive or inside Google Drive).
6. Install: double-click scripts\install.bat, wait for **Installed.** (about 2 minutes; if "Windows protected your PC" appears, **More info → Run anyway**).

Start and set up the shop

7. Start the server: double-click scripts\start_billing.bat and keep the black window open (minimise it).
8. Open billing: double-click scripts\open_billing.bat (or go to http://localhost:8000 in Chrome/Edge).
9. First screen: type the owner's name and a 6–8 digit PIN, then choose **Counter 1**.
10. Settings (owner): fill shop details (name, phones, address, bottom-of-bill lines), bill numbers, and GST if used.
11. Settings → People & PINs: add each staff member with a 4–8 digit PIN.
12. Load stock: **Products → Import from Excel** → pick Cracker_Inventory_new.xlsx (it's in the folder) → set "Add and take off stock at" to **Shop** → **Import**.

Bill printer (on each laptop)

13. Has a printer: install its driver and make it the **Windows default printer**; bills print on **Save & print**.
14. No printer: counter button at the bottom of the menu → **Bill printer → No printer**; the button becomes **Save**, and you send bills with **Send on WhatsApp**.

Second counter (optional)

15. On the main laptop: set the shop Wi-Fi to **Private** (Windows Settings → Network), then right-click scripts\allow_network.bat → **Run as administrator**.
16. Note address 2 from the black window (e.g. http://192.168.1.20:8000).
17. On Counter 2: copy the scripts folder, open open_billing.bat http://192.168.1.20:8000, log in, choose **Counter 2**.

Make it automatic (optional)
18. Double-click scripts\setup_autostart.bat once, so billing starts whenever the laptop is switched on.

Backups (optional, recommended)
19. Install Google Drive for Desktop and sign in with the shop's Google account.
20. Settings → Backup: paste a Drive folder path (e.g. G:\My Drive\SriVinayagaBackups) and press **Back up now**.
21. Backups are then automatic: **Hourly** (7 AM–10 PM) and **Day** (day close and 11 PM), saved in data\backups.

If something breaks
22. "Screens are missing" → the folder is incomplete; download and extract the ZIP again.
23. "Billing is already running" → it's already on; just open open_billing.bat.
24. Counter 2 can't connect → same Wi-Fi? black window open? Wi-Fi set to **Private**? allow_network.bat run as administrator? using address 2?
25. Bill didn't print → printer on with paper and set as **Windows default** (not OneNote/PDF)? opened via open_billing.bat? this laptop set to **Printer connected**?
26. Forgot a PIN → owner resets staff PINs in Settings → People & PINs; for the owner's own PIN run scripts\reset_pin.bat.

To start fresh later: scripts\clear_data.bat → type YES deletes everything and brings back the first-time Set up screen (backups are kept, and a copy is saved first).